

Burns - Thermal - Female (Child)

Algorithm 1008 | Child (0-17 years) | Gender at birth: Female

Definition

- Thermal burn/scald severity assessment decomposed from NHS.UK's published when-to-get-help guidance.
- Child patient.
- Female.

Initial assessment

1. [OPEN_TEXT] What is the person's exact age and sex, are they pregnant, and what caused the burn?
Record location, estimated size/depth, circumferential involvement, inhalation/electrical/chemical exposure, first aid already given, and child/vulnerable-person safeguarding concerns.
2. [OPEN_TEXT] What caused the burn, and roughly how big is the affected area?
3. [DURATION] When did the burn happen, and has cool running water already been applied?
4. [CAREGIVER_OBSERVATION] What has a safe parent or caregiver observed about alertness, breathing, pain, swelling, fever, eating or drinking, sleep, play, and normal activity?

Triage and redirect questions

1. Redirect → Burns - Chemical

Was the burn caused by an acid or another chemical rather than dry heat, hot liquid, or steam?

A chemical burn requires the authored Burns - Chemical pathway and immediate substance-specific decontamination precautions. Electrical exposure remains in the thermal-burn emergency rule-out rather than this redirect.

1. Disposition level 100

Is the burn very large or deep, on the face, genitals, or bottom, or was it caused by an acid, chemical, or electricity?

NHS.UK burns and scalds guidance lists large/deep burns, burns to the face/genitals/bottom, and chemical or electrical burns as emergency ambulance or Emergency Department criteria.

1. Disposition level 70

Is the caller unsure how serious the burn is, or is the patient a child under 5?

NHS.UK guidance recommends seeking urgent clinical review whenever there is uncertainty about a burn or scald, and specifically for children under 5.

1. Disposition level 15

Is this a small, superficial burn or scald with none of the features above?

NHS.UK guidance describes small burns/scalds as manageable at home with first aid.

Advice

Qatar emergency burn response

- Call Qatar emergency services on 999 and do not drive for airway/inhalation injury, electrical or chemical burn, major/deep/circumferential burn, face/neck/genital/hand/major-joint involvement, shock, or an unwell infant/child. Stop the burning source if safe, remove loose jewellery/clothing but not material stuck to skin, and cool a thermal burn with cool running water while preventing whole-body chilling. Brush off dry chemical first and follow 999 instructions. Do not use ice, creams, oils, or adhesive dressings. Call Qatar 999 now, follow the call-taker's ambulance and emergency-transport instructions, and do not self-drive. Do not delay emergency care.
- Call Back If: shock or reduced consciousness; increasing breathing difficulty or soot around airway; rapid swelling or circumferential burn.

Urgent burn review

- Cool the burn under cool running water for 15-30 minutes, cover loosely with cling film (not wrapped around the limb), and arrange same-day medical advice.
- Call Back If: increasing pain or swelling; signs of infection.

Governed first aid for a clearly minor thermal burn

- Cool with cool running water, remove nearby loose jewellery/clothing before swelling but not anything stuck, prevent whole-body chilling, and cover loosely with a clean non-stick dressing. Do not burst blisters or apply ice, butter, toothpaste, creams, or adhesive material. Pain medicine requires age, weight, pregnancy, allergy, kidney/liver disease, and current-medicine checks.
- Call Back If: increasing redness, pus, fever, swelling, or pain; blistering, deep/white/charred skin, or functional-area involvement.

First aid

- Call Qatar emergency services on 999 and do not drive for airway/inhalation injury, electrical or chemical burn, major/deep/circumferential burn, face/neck/genital/hand/major-joint involvement, shock, or an unwell infant/child. Stop the burning source if safe, remove loose jewellery/clothing but not material stuck to skin, and cool a thermal burn with cool running water while preventing whole-body chilling. Brush off dry chemical first and follow 999 instructions. Do not use ice, creams, oils, or adhesive dressings. Call Qatar 999 now, follow the

call-taker's ambulance and emergency-transport instructions, and do not self-drive. Do not delay emergency care.

References

- NHS.UK, "Burns and scalds", <https://www.nhs.uk/conditions/burns-and-scalds/> (page last reviewed 31 March 2026)

Provenance

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